OFFICIAL PRODUCT SPECIFICATION V1.0

Platform Information Architecture, Onboarding Frames & User Flows

A comprehensive UX and technical reference manual covering ideakicks' core personas, hierarchical taxonomy, interactive onboarding frames, complete multi-state user flows, and full feature sitemap.

TARGET PLATFORM: Web / Responsive • PRIMARY COLOR: #6FD179 / #082D4D • DATE: September 2026

Document Scope & Deliverables

- **Detailed Information Architecture:** Global structural model, taxonomy, multi-entity relationships, and role-based permissions.
- **Onboarding Flow Wireframe Frames:** High-fidelity wireframe states for user onboarding, creator project wizard, and pledge checkout.
- **End-to-End User Flows:** Algorithmic decision trees and happy/edge case paths for Creators, Backers, Partners, and Account Ops.
- **Comprehensive Feature Sitemap:** Route index, component layout, authentication tiers, and key conversion metrics.

Core MVP Architectural Principles

- **3-Persona Focused:** Purpose-built for *Creators* (campaign launchers), *Backers* (project funders), and *Partners* (service & production allies).
- **Zero Dark Patterns & Flat Depth:** Direct access to Settings, Profile, and Sign Out from the global header.
- **Curated Quality Gate:** 48-hour human review workflow for all campaigns, ensuring backer trust and high fulfillment rates.
- **Flexible Funding Integrity:** Keep-what-you-raise model with transparent fees and Milestone-based reward scheduling.

Platform Summary & Target Ecosystem

ideakicks bridges the gap between early-stage innovation and passionate micro-communities. By combining a hands-on creator mentorship model with flexible pledge options and verified manufacturing partners, the platform lowers the friction from concept to physical fulfillment.

1. Detailed Information Architecture (IA) HIERARCHY & TAXONOMY

The ideakicks Information Architecture is structured to minimize navigational depth, separate public exploration from transactional tooling, and establish distinct, context-aware workspaces.

1.1 Structural Hierarchy & Global Navigation Layers

LAYER	PRIMARY COMPONENTS	ROUTES & ACCESS	UX INTENT & NAVIGATION BEHAVIOR
Tier 0: Global Frame	Dynamic Glass Header, Mobile Drawer, Quick Search, User Menu, Footer	All public and dashboard views (hidden inside Creator Studio editor)	Persistent brand anchor; quick search overlay; instant access to Profile / Settings / Sign Out.
Tier 1: Discovery & Entry	Home, Explore Grid, Persona Hubs (Creators, Backers, Partners), About, How it Works	`/`, `/explore`, `/start`, `/backers`, `/partners`, `/how-it-works`	Public engagement, category filtering, search relevancy, proof points, and conversion triggers.
Tier 2: Transaction & Conversion	Campaign Detail, Tier Selector, Backing Checkout, Project Wizard (Apply)	`/campaign/:id`, `/campaign/:id/back`, `/start/application`	High-focus, distraction-free transactional funnels with real-time validation and progress feedback.
Tier 3: Account & Management	Dashboard (Overview, Backed, Saved, Campaigns, Notifications, Settings), Creator Studio	`/dashboard`, `/creator-studio/:id` (Protected)	Self-service hub for pledges, campaign milestone tracking, update publishing, and profile security.
Tier 4: Legal & Support	Terms of Service, Privacy Policy, Cookie Settings, Accessibility, Contact Us	`/legal?tab=*`, `/contact`, `/pricing`	Compliance documentation, dispute management, transparent pricing breakdowns, and direct support.

1.2 Core Data Architecture & Entity Relationship Model

User / Profile — Entity

- `id`, `email`, `role` (Creator / Backer / Partner)
- `displayName`, `username`, `bio`, `avatarUrl`
- `interests[]` (Categories for recommendations)
- `backedProjectIds[]`, `savedProjectIds[]`
- `notificationPrefs`, `kycStatus` (Stripe)

Campaign / Project — Entity

- `id`, `creatorId`, `title`, `category`
- `fundingGoal`, `amountRaised`, `backersCount`
- `daysRemaining`, `status` (Draft/InReview/Live/Funded)
- `media` (Banner, Gallery, Video Pitch)
- `storyMarkdown`, `rewards[]`, `milestones[]`

Pledge / Backing — Entity

- `id`, `backerId`, `campaignId`, `rewardId`
- `pledgeAmount`, `shippingCost`, `totalPaid`
- `paymentStatus` (Authorized/Captured/Refunded)
- `fulfillmentStatus` (Pending/InProduction/Shipped)
- `shippingAddress`, `deliveryEta`

1.3 Category Taxonomy & Tagging Hierarchy

12 Core Project Taxonomies

Technology & AI · Design & Hardware · Games & Interactive · Publishing & Writing · Music & Audio · Film & Animation · Art & Creative · Environment & Eco

Lifecycle Status Index

[Draft] In-progress creator application within Project Wizard.

[In Review] Submitted for manual 48-hour curation review.

[Live] Actively accepting backer pledges; counter live.

Food & Beverage | Fashion & Wearables | Education & EdTech | Health & Wellness

[Funded] Funding timeframe completed; reward production active.

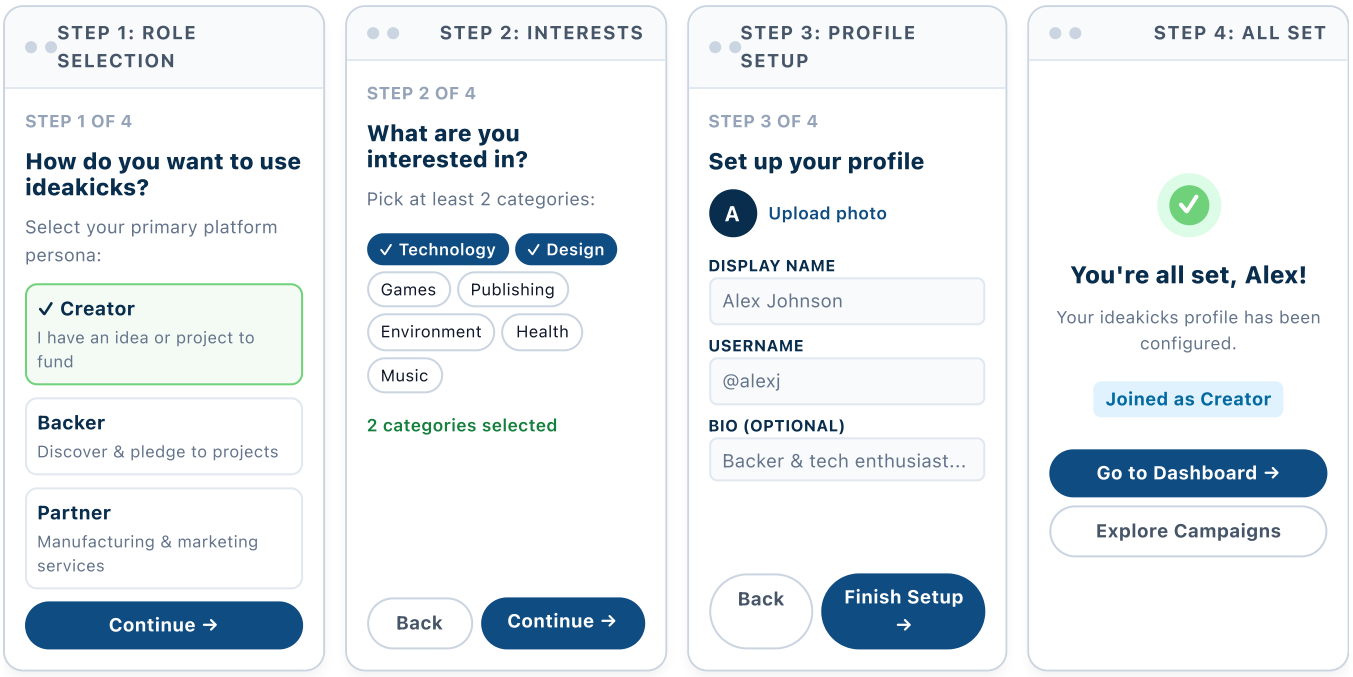
[Fulfillment] Goods shipped, updates posted, backers satisfied.

2. Onboarding Flow Frames

WIREFRAME VISUALS

Interactive wireframe frames showing the exact step-by-step visual UI layout for platform user onboarding (Route: `/onboarding`). Features state validation, category personalization, and instant dashboard routing.

2.1 Platform User Onboarding Flow (4-Step Funnel)



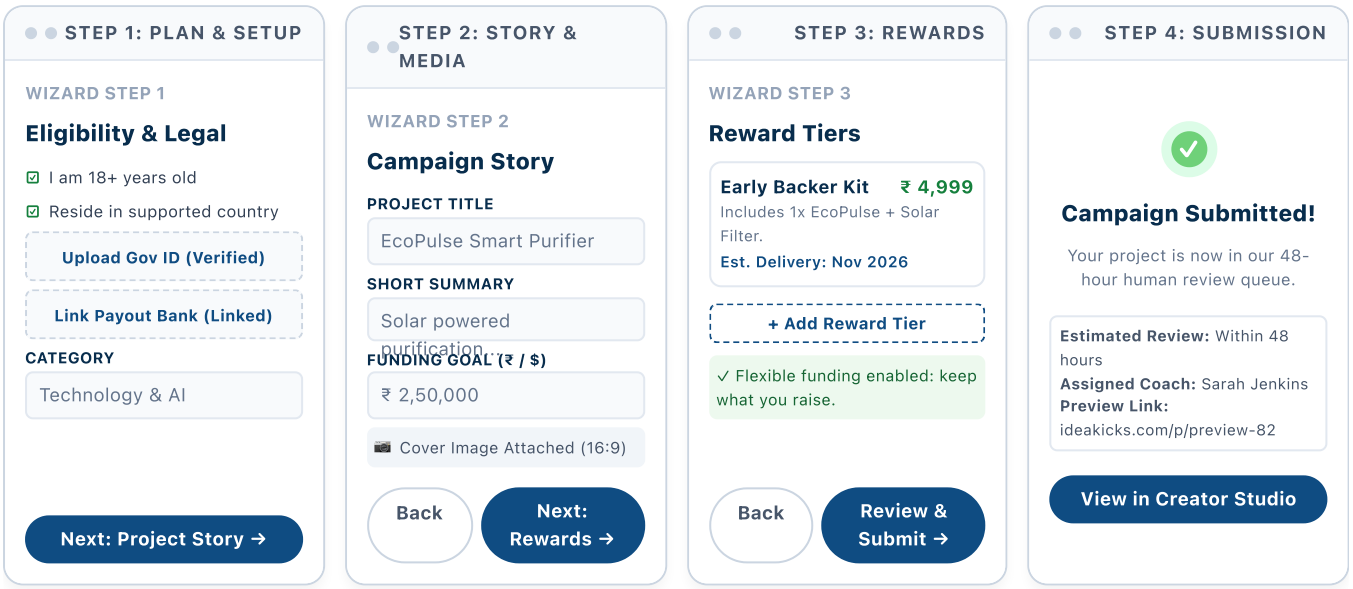
2.2 Frame Architecture & Logic Specifications

FRAME ID	PRIMARY TRIGGERS & INPUTS	VALIDATION RULES	EDGE CASES & EXIT BEHAVIOR
Frame 01: Role	Radio selection: Creator / Backer / Partner	`role !== null` required to enable continue button.	User can skip anytime via top right "Skip" button directly to Dashboard.
Frame 02: Tags	Multi-toggle category tags (12 available).	`selectedCategories.length >=` 2 strictly enforced.	Allows unlimited selection; visual counter alerts user when requirement met.
Frame 03: Profile	Avatar upload, Display Name, Username, Bio.	Display Name > 2 chars, Username alphanumeric lowercase.	Autocompletes username from display name with whitespace removal.
Frame 04: Ready	Action routing: Go to Dashboard or Explore.	Session profile persistence to local state & database.	Deep-links to relevant starting tab based on selected role in Frame 01.

2. Onboarding Flow Frames (Continued) CREATOR PROJECT WIZARD

Visual wireframes for the Creator Project Wizard (Route: `/start/application`). Implements a 4-step progressive disclosure model from legal compliance through reward design to launch submission.

2.3 Creator Project Application Frames (Route: /start/application)



2.4 Backer Pledge & Transaction Wireframe Funnel

1. Campaign Tier Select

Backer views campaign page at `/campaign/:id`. Sticky backing sidebar displays active tiers with remaining counts, pledge totals, and delivery date estimates. Clicking "Back This Project" scrolls to or launches checkout.

2. Frictionless Checkout

Clean single-page checkout at `/campaign/:id/back`. Shows breakdown: Base Pledge + Shipping destination selection + Optional bonus contribution. Integrated with Stripe Payment Element.

3. Instant Confirmation & Dashboard

Confirmation modal generates backer number, receipt, and social sharing links. Immediately appends campaign to user's **Backed Projects** tab in `/dashboard` for real-time progress updates.

3. End-to-End User Flows

INTERACTIVE PATHWAYS

Complete logic diagrams illustrating user state transitions, system validations, branching conditionals, and exception states across ideakicks' core experiences.

3.1 Flow A: The Creator Journey (Ideation to Funded Campaign)

1. Discovery & Intent
Landing at `/start`. Reviews value props (Coach, Network, Flexible Funding) & FAQs.

→

2. Auth Check
Is user authenticated?
YES: To Wizard
NO: `/signup` with redirect

→

3. Project Wizard
Complete 4 stages: Legal ID, Story Media, Reward Tiers, and Stripe Connect.

4. Curation Gate
Human team reviews within 48h. Verified against community guidelines?

→

5a. Revisions Needed
Coach provides actionable feedback in Creator Studio. Re-submit allowed.

or

5b. Approved & Scheduled
Creator schedules launch date or goes live immediately at `/campaign/:id`.

6. Live Campaign Management
Post updates, track pledges in real-time, message backers, and coordinate with verified vendors.

→

7. Funding Close & Payout
Flexible funding settles to linked bank account. Fulfillment status tracked in Dashboard.

3.2 Flow B: The Backer Journey (Discovery to Fulfillment Tracking)

1. Search & Filter
Browses `/explore` by category, funding status, trending, or search keywords.

→

2. Project Deep-Dive
Evaluates pitch, video, creator profile, risk statement, and reward tiers.

→

3. Tier Selection
Selects reward kit or custom pledge without reward.

4. Checkout & Payment
Enters shipping destination & payment info at `/campaign/:id/back`.

→

5. Payment Auth
Card authorized via Stripe.
SUCCESS: Order confirmed
FAIL: Inline retry prompt

→

6. Active Backer State
Added to `/dashboard` Backed list. Receives email updates & milestone alerts.

3.3 Flow C: Account Management & Flat Navigation Flow

Header Profile Dropdown Flow

Entry: User clicks Avatar icon in global header.
Options:
1. **Dashboard:** Opens `/dashboard` (default Overview tab).
2. **Settings:** Deep-links directly to `/dashboard#settings` via URL hash listener.
3. **Sign Out:** Clears session tokens, redirects to `/login` with success toast.
Result: Solves the "unnecessarily deep navigation" UX defect.

Partner / Vendor Collaboration Flow

1. Application: Partner visits `/vendors` and submits capability deck.
2. Vetting: Operations team audits past manufacturing / marketing performance.
3. Matchmaking: Verified partners get listed in Creator Studio vendor directory.
4. Direct Contact: Creators request quotes directly for packaging, injection molding, or digital PR.

4. Comprehensive Feature Sitemap

ROUTE INDEX & COMPONENTS

Full technical tree and route registry detailing URL endpoints, access requirements, primary modules, interaction states, and conversion metrics across the application.

4.1 Complete Application Route & Component Specification

ROUTE PATH	ACCESS TIER	CORE PAGE MODULES	INTERACTIVE COMPONENTS & STATES	CONVERSION GOAL & TECHNICAL OUTPUT
`/`	Public	Hero, 3-Persona Pillars, Featured Campaigns, Value Props, Global CTA	Category filter pills, Campaign preview cards, Video preview modal	Route user to `/start` (Creator) or `/explore` (Backer). Zero unverified metrics.
`/explore`	Public	Search Filter Bar, Category Badges, Sort Controls, Responsive Project Grid	Live search query, Category multi-toggle, Sort by Funding/Ending Soon, Pagination	Card click-through to `/campaign/:id`; bookmark to Saved.
`/start`	Public	Creator Hero, 3 Starting Stages, What We Provide, 4-Step Journey, FAQs	Interactive FAQ accordion, Stage selection cards, Direct application CTA	Primary creator conversion gate leading to `/start/application`.
`/start/application`	Auth Required	4-Step Project Wizard: Eligibility, Story & Media, Reward Builder, Submit	ID verification upload, Month-year calendar picker, Dynamic reward tier adder, Stripe KYC	Inserts draft into database; initiates 48-hour human review protocol.
`/campaign/:id`	Public	Campaign Header, Video Player, Story Body, Reward Selector, Creator Bio	Pledge tier cards with hover elevation, Bookmark button, Social share dialog	Back project trigger routing to `/campaign/:id/back`.
`/campaign/:id/back`	Auth Required	Checkout Summary, Reward Tier Selection, Shipping Form, Stripe Element	Real-time shipping calculation, Payment card validation, One-click Apple/Google Pay	Payment capture; creates Backing record; sends confirmation email.
`/dashboard`	Auth Required	Profile Header, Nav Tabs: Overview, Backed, Saved, Campaigns, Notifications, Settings	Hash listener (`#settings`), Unread notification badges, Tab switching, Save forms	Primary user retention and management interface. Includes direct Sign Out.
`/creator-studio/:id`	Creator Only	Analytics Dashboard, Backer CRM, Update Composer, Milestone Tracker	Markdown WYSIWYG editor, CSV export of backer orders, Fulfillment checklist	Post-launch creator workspace for backer communication and fulfillment.

ROUTE PATH	ACCESS TIER	CORE PAGE MODULES	INTERACTIVE COMPONENTS & STATES	CONVERSION GOAL & TECHNICAL OUTPUT
`/backers`	**Public**	Backer Value Props, Guarantee Explanation, Trending Projects	Interactive backing calculator, Trust badge popovers	Education and conversion of first-time crowdfunding backers.
`/vendors`	**Public**	Partner Value Props, Directory of Capabilities, Partnership Application	Application form with file upload for capability decks	Lead generation for verified manufacturing and marketing vendors.
`/login` & `/signup`	**Public**	Authentication Forms, Google OAuth, Password Recovery Links	Inline field validation, Password show/hide, Remember session token	Authentication cookie setup; redirects to intended destination or `/onboarding`.
`/legal`	**Public**	Terms of Service, Privacy Policy, Cookie Policy, Accessibility Statement	Tabbed document reader synchronized with `?tab=*` query params	GDPR, CCPA, and payment compliance disclosures.

4.2 Navigation Tree & Redirection Matrix

- `/` **Homepage** (Public Entry)
  - `/explore` Project Discovery & Search Grid
  - `/start` Creator Landing → `/start/application` Wizard
  - `/backers` Backer Hub & Protection Overview
  - `/vendors` Partner & Production Network
  - `/mentors` & `/investors` *(Redirects cleanly to `/contact` in MVP)*
  - `/dashboard` User Workspace [Overview | Backed | Saved | Campaigns | Notifications | Settings]
  - `/legal` Compliance Hub [Terms | Privacy | Cookies | Accessibility]

5. Technical & UX Implementation Standards

QUALITY & SECURITY

Architecture standards governing state restoration, accessibility benchmarks, design tokens, and defensive error handling across all frontend modules.

5.1 Navigation & Scroll Engine

To resolve critical scroll persistence bugs, the global layout mounts a dedicated `ScrollToTop` listener hooked into React Router's `useLocation()`:

```
useEffect(() => {
  window.scrollTo({ top: 0, left: 0, behavior:
'instant' });
}, [pathname]);
```

Guarantees that all sub-route changes load with the viewport focused cleanly at the top hero section.

5.2 Design Tokens & Visual Hierarchy

Primary Brand	#6FD179 (Accent Green)
Deep Navy (Base)	#082D4D (Headings & Dark BG)
Secondary Blue	#0F4C82 (Primary Buttons & Links)
Typography	Clash Display (Headings) / Satoshi (Body)
Border Radius	Cards: 16px / Buttons: 9999px (Pill)

5.3 Accessibility & Responsive Performance Matrix

WCAG 2.1 AA Compliance

All text elements maintain a minimum 4.5:1 contrast ratio against backdrops. Form controls feature explicit labels and aria attributes for screen readers.

Touch & Mobile Ergonomics

Interactive click targets meet or exceed 44×44px. Full-width sticky CTA buttons deployed on mobile breakpoints to ensure effortless one-handed thumb interaction.

Glassmorphism Performance

Header uses dynamic Alpha + Blur interpolation throttled to passive scroll event listeners, avoiding layout recalculation and jank.

Ready for Production Execution

This specification document reflects the active architecture of ideakicks. All components, routes, and styling tokens conform to `DESIGN_SYSTEM.md`.

APPROVED SPECIFICATION

ideakicks Core Architecture Group